

String.prototype.indexOf()

The **indexOf()** method, given one argument: a substring to search for, searches the entire calling string, and returns the index of the first occurrence of the specified substring. Given a second argument: a number, the method returns the first occurrence of the specified substring at an index greater than or equal to the specified number.

Try it

JavaScript Demo: String.indexOf()

```
1 const paragraph = 'The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog. If the dog ba
2
3 const searchTerm = 'dog';
4 const indexOfFirst = paragraph.indexOf(searchTerm);
5
6 console.log(`The index of the first "${searchTerm}" from the beginning is ${i
7 // expected output: "The index of the first "dog" from the beginning is 40"
8
9 console.log(`The index of the 2nd "${searchTerm}" is ${paragraph.indexOf(sear
10 // expected output: "The index of the 2nd "dog" is 52"
11
```

Run › Reset

Syntax

indexOf(searchString)
indexOf(searchString, position)

Parameters

searchString

Substring to search for, [coerced to a string](#).

If the method is called with no arguments, `searchString` is coerced to `"undefined"`. Therefore, `"undefined".indexOf()` returns `0` — because the substring `"undefined"` is found at position `0` in the string `"undefined"`. But `"undefine".indexOf()`, returns `-1` — because the substring `"undefined"` is not found in the string `"undefine"`.

position Optional

The method returns the index of the first occurrence of the specified substring at a position greater than or equal to `position`, which defaults to `0`. If `position` is greater than the length of the calling string, the method doesn't search the calling string at all. If `position` is less than zero, the method behaves as it would if `position` were `0`.